

TRANSLATE YOUR OWN SKILLS

A worksheet for service leavers who can't yet name what they've already been doing

Most of what gets called "logistics," "engineering" or "admin" in Service life is, in civilian language, governance, risk and compliance work: control ownership, audit, verification, exception handling. Nobody hands you the translation on the way out. This worksheet is the exercise I ran on my own eighteen years to write it myself: you can run it on yours in about twenty minutes.

THE METHOD

1. Write down one task you do routinely. Be specific: not "logistics," but "checking a consignment against its paperwork before I sign for it."
2. Ask what the task is actually verifying, and what would go wrong if it were skipped. This is the part that usually gets left out of a CV.
3. Match it to the nearest civilian control language. You don't need a perfect fit: a plausible match is enough to start a conversation with a recruiter or hiring manager who knows the framework.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Two rows from my own version of this exercise, published in full as "Same Control, Two Vocabularies" at kelroyjames.com:

What I Actually Do	What It's Verifying	Civilian Control Language
Supersession check before signing for equipment	The asset register matches physical reality before I accept liability for it	ISO 27001 Annex A asset verification; Three Lines Model, first-line control ownership
Stocktake variance investigation	Whether a discrepancy is a process failure, a recording error, or a genuine loss	Root-cause analysis; COSO Control Activities component

Full table (nine rows, mapped against ISO 27001, ISO 19011, COSO and the Three Lines Model): kelroyjames.com/same-control-two-vocabularies.html

YOUR TURN

Fill in as many rows as you can before you stop to second-guess yourself. A rough answer you can refine later beats a blank row.

What I Actually Do	What It's Verifying	Civilian Control Language

IF YOU'RE STUCK: A ROUGH STARTING POINT BY TRADE AREA

These are starting points, not answers: your own task is always more specific than the trade area it sits in.

Trade Area	Common Theme	Look Towards
Supply / Logistics	Custody, verification, reconciliation of physical assets against records	Third-party risk, supply chain assurance, internal audit

Trade Area	Common Theme	Look Towards
Engineering / Maintenance	Scheduled inspection, defect reporting, sign-off before use	Quality assurance, ISO 9001/27001 controls, operational risk
Communications / IT	Access control, incident handling, system integrity checks	Information security, ISO 27001, IT audit
Personnel / HR	Vetting, appraisal integrity, conduct investigations	HR compliance, conduct & controls, people risk
Operations / Planning	Contingency planning, exercise debrief, lessons-learned capture	Enterprise risk management, business continuity, internal audit

EVIDENCE APPENDIX: VERIFIED AGAINST OFFICIAL ROLE DESCRIPTIONS

Starting with the trade I can vouch for firsthand. The table below pairs the Royal Navy's own published Logistics profession role descriptions with the nearest civilian control language, rank by rank: not self-report.

Rank	What the Role Does (RN Logistics Profession)	Civilian Control Language
Supply Chain Rating (entry)	Sources, tracks and coordinates delivery of stores and equipment across a global supply chain	Basic inventory/asset control; first-line control execution (Three Lines Model)
Leading Hand	Runs a stores account: sourcing, allocating and accounting for equipment under personal custody	First-line control ownership; asset custody controls (COSO Control Activities)
Petty Officer	Moves into line management: mentoring junior logisticians and owning section-level compliance	First-line management oversight; control environment component (COSO)
Logistics Officer (Lt / Lt Cdr)	Coordinates supply chain, personnel and financial management concurrently across the organisation	Second-line risk and assurance oversight; enterprise risk management; cross-functional governance

Role descriptions summarised from the Royal Navy's published careers pages for the Logistics profession (royalnavy.mod.uk/careers/professions/logistics-and-catering-personnel, accessed September 2026). This also sits inside Defence's own developing skills language: the Pan-Defence Skills Framework, referenced in JSP 822 Defence Training and Education, is moving toward a single common skills vocabulary across the services, and this table is one trade's worth of that translation, done independently.

Engineering, Warfare and Healthcare & Medical are mapped too, as a first pass, not yet checked by someone who held those jobs. Full, growing version: kelroyjames.com/verified-not-self-reported.html

If your trade needs correcting, or isn't there yet, reply and tell me your trade and rank; that's exactly the input I need.

If you've filled this in and want a second pair of eyes on it, or want to talk through where it fits your transition timeline, email me at kelroydbjames@gmail.com: I read every one. More frameworks like this one: kelroyjames.com

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